

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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ANTHONY RICHARDSON,

SUMMONS

Plaintiff, Index No.:

-against-

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of IncidentTHE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD DETECTIVE
ALICKAJ, Shield No. 3862, and NYPD POLICE
OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBER 1-10,Plaintiff designates Bronx
County as the place of trial.

Defendants.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
February 9, 2021

Yours, etc.

_____
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD DETECTIVE ALICKAJ, Shield No. 3862, NYPD 40th Precinct; 257 Alexander
Avenue, The Bronx, NY 10454

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X

ANTHONY RICHARDSON,

INDEX NO.:

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD DETECTIVE
ALICKAJ, Shield No. 3862, and NYPD POLICE
OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10,

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Defendants.

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Plaintiff ANTHONY RICHARDSON, by his attorneys, Caitlin Robin & Associates, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth, and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On September 24, 2020, at approximately 5:00 p.m., plaintiff ANTHONY RICHARDSON, while lawfully inside Cohen Children's Medical Center in Queens, New York, was subject to an unlawful stop, question, frisk, search, false arrest, and false imprisonment by the defendant New York City police officers. In addition, Plaintiff was subjected to defamation of character by the defendant officers, causing him to suffer humiliation and loss of reputation, as well as mental and emotional injury. Plaintiff was then unlawfully imprisoned at the 40th Precinct Police Station in the Bronx for approximately 32 hours before he was released and cleared of the false child endangerment charges, as the Bronx County District Attorney declined to prosecute. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, searched, confined, subjected to excessive force, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, and denied plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff ANTHONY RICHARDSON is a resident of the state of New York.
3. NYPD DETECTIVE ALICKAJ, SHIELD NO. 3862, is and was at all times relevant herein an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
4. NYPD DETECTIVE ALICKAJ, SHIELD NO. 3862, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 40th Precinct.
5. NYPD DETECTIVE ALICKAJ, SHIELD NO. 3862, is being sued in his individual and official capacities.
6. NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.
7. NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 were at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 40th Precinct.
8. NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE NUMBERS 1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.
9. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.
10. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.
11. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.
12. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on January 25, 2021.
13. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

14. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

15. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

16. On September 24, 2020, at approximately 5:00 P.M., Plaintiff was lawfully present inside Cohen Children's Medical Center in Queens, New York, when the defendant police officers unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, and falsely arrested Plaintiff without probable cause or legal justification.

17. The previous night, Plaintiff had picked up his 5-year-old granddaughter from her grandmother's house to spend the night with him at his apartment in The Bronx, which she had done in the past.

18. The granddaughter's 3-year-old friend was also at the grandmother's house, and she went with Plaintiff and his granddaughter to spend the night, with knowledge and permission from the girls' guardians.

19. When the Plaintiff went to wake the two girls the following day, he found the 3-year-old girl to be unusually lethargic and unwilling to get up. After allowing her to sleep in a bit longer, the plaintiff found her to be unresponsive.

20. He carried the girl to his car and drove her directly to the nearest children's hospital, Cohen Children's Medical Center in Queens, which he had used in the past and knew to have a good reputation.

21. Once at the emergency room and having made sure the girl was given immediate attention by medical professionals, the plaintiff proceeded to call the 5-year-old's grandmother to let her know about the events that were unfolding with her granddaughter's friend.

22. At some point after the girl was taken back to be seen at the hospital, Plaintiff was taken into a back room to be questioned by Queens police.

23. Having satisfactorily answered their questions, the Queens police officers released the Plaintiff from the room, advising him that he might also be contacted by Bronx police for questioning.

24. After the Queens police left the hospital, Plaintiff received news via a phone call that the 3-year-old girl had passed away from COVID-19 coupled with pneumonia. Plaintiff had not been made aware that the girl was sick before she was placed in his care.

25. Shortly thereafter, at around 5:00p.m., approximately five officers from Bronx police arrived at Cohen Children's Medical Center and approached the Plaintiff.

26. Plaintiff indicated to defendant officers that he knew they were there to question him and that he was ready and willing to do so.

27. It was at this point that the defendant NYPD officers began to unlawfully arrest the plaintiff, restraining him with metal handcuffs and subjecting him to an unlawful pat-down search.

28. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

29. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

30. Plaintiff was handcuffed in front of his granddaughter, who began crying when she saw the police arresting him.

31. Plaintiff did not resist arrest.

32. The Defendant Officers then placed the Plaintiff in the back of an NYPD vehicle and transported him against his will to the 40th Precinct, where he was unlawfully fingerprinted, photographed, and placed in a holding cell.

33. After being unlawfully detained at the 40th precinct, Plaintiff was taken into an interrogation room, was insulted, and was called a criminal.

34. A short time later, Plaintiff was transported to Bronx County Central bookings and unlawfully detained in a holding cell.

35. The defendant police officers provided the Bronx County District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.

36. Specifically, the defendant police officers falsely stated to the Bronx County District Attorney's Office that the plaintiff was guilty of Endangering the Welfare of a Child causing the death of a minor.

37. While the plaintiff was still in custody, defendant NYPD officers leaked false information to local newspapers alleging that he had caused the death of the 3-year-old girl, severely damaging his reputation in his community:

- <https://abc7ny.com/3-year-old-dies-man-charged-bronx-to-queens-cohen-childrens-medical-center/6561817/>
- <https://newyork.cbslocal.com/2020/09/26/3-year-old-girl-dies-at-sleepover/>
- <https://www.pix11.com/news/local-news/bronx/bronx-man-arrested-in-death-of-3-year-old-girl>
- <https://nypost.com/2020/09/25/man-arrested-for-driving-unconscious-toddler-to-distant-hospital/>

38. The Bronx County District Attorney declined to prosecute the Plaintiff on these charges, as he committed no crime.

39. On September 26, 2020, after approximately 32 hours in unlawful police custody, Plaintiff was released from custody with no charges.

40. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably searching, seizing, using excessive force, falsely arresting and imprisoning, humiliating, and denying Plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial.

41. The unlawful search, seizure, use of excessive force, false arrest and imprisonment, and denial of Plaintiff's right to a fair trial by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

42. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 41 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

43. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

44. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

45. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 44 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

46. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

47. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

48. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

49. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

50. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop, Question, and Frisk

51. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 50 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

52. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, questioning, and frisk employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

53. The conduct of defendants in stopping, frisking, and searching Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

54. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

55. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

56. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

57. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 56 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

58. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

59. Defendants lacked probable cause to search Plaintiff.

60. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

61. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

62. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

63. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

64. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 63 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

65. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

66. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

67. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Bronx County District Attorney's Office.

68. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff ANTHONY RICHARDSON, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

69. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff ANTHONY RICHARDSON sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

70. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

71. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

72. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights

73. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 72 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

74. The use of excessive force by defendants by, amongst other things, tightly handcuffing him and detaining him for almost two days, constituted objectively unreasonable physical seizures of Plaintiff in violation of his rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

75. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of his employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

76. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 75 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

77. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff, ANTHONY RICHARDSON. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

78. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

79. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

80. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

81. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

82. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Defamation of Character

83. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs 1 through 82 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

84. Defendants, individually and collectively, provided false information pertaining to the events relevant herein to local news outlets, before any decision could be reached as to whether to proceed with the prosecution of the plaintiff on any charges.

85. Specifically, defendants made slanderous statements to reporters that Plaintiff, ANTHONY RICHARDSON, had caused the death of a child by negligently and/or intentionally delaying her medical care, after which this false information implicating the plaintiff was printed and spread far and wide, as shown in the links to news sources provided herein.

86. After defendant officers relayed this false and misleading information to local news outlets, the plaintiff suffered humiliation, loss of respect from his peers, and diminished reputation in his own community, consequences which would all prove to be permanent even though he was very soon cleared of all charges falsely made against him.

87. The propagation of these false and misleading claims to popular news sources constitute clear defamation of character inflicted upon the plaintiff by defendant officers.

88. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

89. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

90. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

91. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

92. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 91 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

93. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

94. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

95. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 94 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

96. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

97. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

98. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to unlawful search and other physical constraints.

99. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

100. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

101. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

102. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

103. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff ANTHONY RICHARDSON demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
February 9, 2021

By: 
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD DETECTIVE ALICKAJ, SHIELD NO. 3862, NYPD 40th Precinct; 257
Alexander Avenue, The Bronx, NY 10454

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

CAITLIN ROBIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the

State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a member of the law firm of **CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York

February 9, 2021



CAITLIN ROBIN